

Ride Booking Platform

Project Scope & Technical Plan — Revision 2

Prepared by Muhammad Hannan · Revised 4 August 2026 (*Revision 1: 29 July 2026*)

Revision Summary — What Changed in This Version

Revision 1 scoped a Next.js + FastAPI stack running as Docker containers on a self-managed Hostinger VPS. Revision 2 changes the delivery architecture and hosting, for the reasons given below. **Scope, features, phases, timeline, and design direction are unchanged.**

#	Change	Reason
1	Backend moves from FastAPI (Python) → Next.js route handlers	Two runtimes were forcing a larger, self-managed server. One runtime removes a container, a deploy target, and the cross-service auth plumbing — with no loss of capability for a CRUD booking app.
2	Database moves from self-hosted PostgreSQL → MySQL (included with hosting)	Removes a second vendor and the network hop. MySQL's <code>JSON</code> and <code>ENUM</code> types map cleanly onto the Section 5 schema — no modelling loss.
3	Hosting moves from self-managed VPS → Hostinger Business (managed)	See Section 12. The deciding factor is maintenance liability, not cost.
4	Docker / Nginx / Certbot removed from the production stack	Managed hosting handles process supervision and SSL. Docker remains in use for local development only.
5	Distance API changed to Google Routes API	Distance Matrix is Google's legacy product and is on a deprecation path.
6	Reference codes lengthened and randomised	Security fix — see Section 5.1.
7	New Section 17 — Recommendations to the Client	Operational and commercial advice that sits outside the build itself.

1. Project Overview

This document scopes a chauffeur/ride-booking web platform for a client, inspired by the reference site C2C Rides (Dubai). The goal is a lean, buildable MVP that captures the core booking experience without requiring live GPS dispatch, a driver app, or payment gateway integration on day one.

The plan is based on direct analysis of the reference platform's real customer flow (booking confirmation emails and WhatsApp interaction observed first-hand), not just its marketing pages.

2. How the Reference Platform (C2C Rides) Actually Works

Testing the live site revealed a two-stage confirmation process — the booking is not instantly confirmed on submission:

- Customer submits a booking request through the website (route, date/time, vehicle category, passenger/luggage count).
- An automated transactional email is sent immediately: "Booking Request Received", including a reference number, route summary, distance/duration estimate, and requested date/time.
- A human admin follows up manually over WhatsApp Business (regular app, not the WhatsApp Cloud API) to confirm details and coordinate.
- The admin manually assigns a driver off-platform (phone call / WhatsApp) — there is no evidence of automated dispatch.
- Once confirmed, a second "Booking Confirmed" message/email is sent with the final reference details and a link to a public tracking page.
- The site's "Live Chat" button is a plain WhatsApp click-to-chat link (`api.whatsapp.com/send`), not an API integration — free to replicate, no approval process needed.

Conclusion: the sophisticated part of this business is manual, human coordination. The software's job is to make that coordination fast and organized — not to replace it with automation the client doesn't need yet.

3. Proposed Booking Flow (What We Will Build)

Step	Actor	What Happens
1. Submit booking	Customer	Fills booking form on website (ride / hourly / airport / city tour)
2. Auto-confirmation	System	Reference code generated; instant email sent with booking summary
3. Admin review	Admin	Sees new request in dashboard; contacts customer via WhatsApp deep link
4. Driver assignment	Admin	Manually contacts a driver (phone/WhatsApp); marks booking "assigned" in dashboard with driver name/number
5. Status updates	Admin	Updates status: en route → completed (or cancelled)
6. Tracking	Customer	Enters reference code on a public tracking page to see current status + driver info once assigned

4. Feature Scope by Phase

Phase 1 — MVP (Feasibility Build)

- Public booking form: Ride / Hourly / City Tour / Airport tabs
- Fields: from/to (or duration for hourly), date/time, vehicle category, passenger & luggage count, WhatsApp number, flight number (airport only)
- Auto-calculated distance/duration via Google Routes API (shown to customer + admin)
- Reference code generation + instant confirmation email
- Admin dashboard: list of bookings, filter by status/date, one-click status updates
- Manual driver assignment: dropdown of saved drivers, attaches name + WhatsApp number to booking
- WhatsApp deep-links (`wa.me`) prefilled with booking reference — for both customer-to-admin and admin-to-driver contact
- Public "Track your booking" page (lookup by reference code)
- Static content pages: Home, Services, About, FAQ, Contact

Phase 2 — Once Validated

- Online payments (Stripe — see Section 16)
- Customer accounts + booking history
- Driver-facing portal (accept/update ride status without relying on admin relay)
- Multi-currency support
- Corporate / travel-agency account types
- Courier service module
- Customer review collection

Phase 3 — Scale

- Live GPS tracking (Google Maps / Mapbox real-time location)
- Automated driver dispatch / matching logic
- Partner/driver self-onboarding portal
- Dynamic pricing
- SMS / push notifications

5. Data Model

Changed in Rev 2: engine is MySQL rather than PostgreSQL. Types below are given as MySQL equivalents. The logical model is unchanged.

bookings

Field	Type	Notes
id	CHAR(36)	Primary key (UUID)
reference_code	VARCHAR(16)	Unique. See 5.1 — format changed in Rev 2
service_type	ENUM	ride / hourly / city_tour / airport / courier
pickup_location	VARCHAR + lat/lng	Address + optional decimal lat/lng columns
dropoff_location	VARCHAR + lat/lng	Nullable for hourly bookings
stops	JSON	Optional array of intermediate stops
pickup_datetime	DATETIME	
duration_hours	INT	Nullable, hourly bookings only
flight_number	VARCHAR	Nullable, airport rides only
vehicle_category	ENUM	Comfort / Business / SUV / VIP / Van
passenger_count	INT	
luggage_count	INT	
distance_km	DECIMAL	Auto-calculated
duration_min	INT	Auto-calculated
fare_estimate	DECIMAL	
customer_name	VARCHAR	
customer_whatsapp	VARCHAR	
customer_email	VARCHAR	Nullable
status	ENUM	requested / confirmed / assigned / en_route / completed / cancelled
created_at	DATETIME	

Changed in Rev 2: the status enum previously listed both `requested` and `awaiting_confirmation`. As described in Section 3 these are the same state, so `awaiting_confirmation` has been removed. **Flagged for review** — if the client intends a distinction (e.g. "submitted" vs "admin has seen it"), say so and it goes back in.

drivers

Field	Type	Notes
id	CHAR(36)	Primary key
name	VARCHAR	
whatsapp_number	VARCHAR	
vehicle_assigned	VARCHAR	Nullable
active	BOOLEAN	Available for assignment

booking_assignments

Field	Type	Notes
booking_id	CHAR(36)	FK → bookings
driver_id	CHAR(36)	FK → drivers
assigned_at	DATETIME	
notes	TEXT	e.g. "confirmed via WhatsApp at 3:40pm"

5.1 Reference Code Format — Security Change (New in Rev 2)

Revision 1 used a short sequential example (C2C-4821). Because the public tracking page (Section 9) is unauthenticated and returns the customer's name, WhatsApp number, pickup address and travel time, a four-digit sequential code means the entire customer database can be enumerated by trying codes in order.

Revised format: an 8-character random code from a non-ambiguous alphabet (e.g. C2C-7K4M2XQP), with a uniqueness constraint and retry-on-collision. Rate limiting on the tracking lookup endpoint.

This costs nothing to implement now and cannot be retrofitted once codes are printed in customer emails. Recommended regardless of budget.

6. Tech Stack (Revised)

Layer	Choice
Frontend + Backend	Next.js (App Router) + TypeScript + Tailwind. UI and API in one application; API implemented as route handlers. Replaces the separate FastAPI service.
Database	MySQL , included with the Hostinger Business plan. Accessed via Drizzle ORM with versioned migrations.
Auth (admin)	Session-based auth implemented in Next.js middleware; password hashed with argon2. Single admin account seeded from environment variables.
Distance / fare calc	Google Routes API (<code>computeRouteMatrix</code>). Called server-side only; results cached per rounded origin/destination pair to limit billable elements.
Transactional email	Resend (HTTPS API)
Customer contact	WhatsApp click-to-chat (<code>wa.me</code> links) — no API cost
Hosting	Hostinger Business plan (managed Node.js hosting), 12-month term
SSL	Included and managed by host
Deployment	Hostinger's built-in GitHub integration — build on push to <code>main</code>
Local development	Docker Compose (MySQL only) + <code>next dev</code>
Pre-launch staging	Vercel free tier + free hosted MySQL (Aiven or TiDB Cloud serverless) — see Section 12.4

Removed from Rev 1: FastAPI, self-hosted PostgreSQL, Docker in production, Nginx reverse proxy, Certbot, VPS provisioning and maintenance.

Pricing model note: fares are computed from a `vehicle_category` → `base` + `per_km` + `per_min` + `minimum` table stored in the database, not hardcoded. This is the value most likely to change after client feedback and must be editable without a redeploy.

7. Cost & API Breakdown (Revised)

7.1 Service-by-Service

Service	Used For	Free Tier	Cost Beyond Free Tier
WhatsApp (click-to-chat)	Customer ↔ admin ↔ driver contact	Fully free — no API, no approval	N/A
Google Routes API	Distance/duration/fare calc	Monthly free allowance, covers MVP volume	Per-element billing after allowance
Resend	Booking request & confirmation emails	3,000 emails/month, 100/day, 1 domain	\$20/month (Pro) — not needed at MVP volume
Hostinger Business	Node.js app + MySQL + SSL + daily backups	N/A — flat fee	See 7.2
Domain name	e.g. yourbrand.com	Often bundled free for year 1	~\$10–\$15/year thereafter
Vercel + Aiven (staging only)	Pre-launch demo	Free tiers	Temporary; removed at launch

7.2 Total Estimated Cost

Scenario	Cost	Notes
Development phase	\$0	Local only
Pre-launch demo	\$0	Vercel free tier + free hosted MySQL
Phase 1 live launch (Year 1)	~Rs 799/month, 12-month term	Hostinger Business promotional rate. Roughly \$34/year equivalent.
Year 2+ (renewal)	~Rs 2,299/month	Roughly \$98/year equivalent
Plus one-time / annual	\$0–\$15/year	Domain (often bundled free year 1)

Pricing observed in PKR on the client-side account in August 2026; USD equivalents are approximate and FX-dependent. Displayed prices typically exclude local tax. Promotional rates change — the **renewal** figure is the durable number to plan around.

8. Admin Dashboard Requirements

- Booking list with filters (status, date range, service type)
- Booking detail view: full trip info, customer contact, distance/fare
- One-click "Message customer on WhatsApp" (prefilled with reference code)

- Driver assignment: select from active drivers, one-click "Message driver on WhatsApp" (prefilled with pickup/dropoff/time)
- Status update buttons: confirmed → assigned → en route → completed / cancelled
- Simple stats widget: bookings today, pending count, completed this week

9. Customer-Facing Requirements

- Booking form with tabs: Rides / Book Hourly / City Tour
- Instant reference code + confirmation email on submit
- Public tracking page: enter reference code → see current status (and driver info once assigned)
- WhatsApp "Need help?" button site-wide, prefilled with reference code when on a booking-related page
- Static marketing pages: services, fleet categories, about, FAQ, contact

Rev 2 note: the tracking page is unauthenticated and returns customer PII. Mitigations in Section 5.1 (long random codes, rate limiting) apply here.

10. Estimated Timeline (Phase 1 MVP)

Week	Focus
Week 1	Data model + migrations, API route handlers (bookings, drivers), booking form UI, Routes API distance/fare calc
Week 2	Admin dashboard, WhatsApp deep-links, confirmation emails, tracking page, technical SEO, QA + polish

Solo build estimate: 1.5–2 weeks for a fully functional, demoable Phase 1, assuming scope stays as defined.

Rev 2 note: dropping the second runtime and the VPS removes roughly a day of infrastructure work (Docker Compose, Nginx, Certbot, deploy scripting). That margin is absorbed by the expanded Phase 1 page list in Section 14.5 rather than shortening the estimate.

Not included in this estimate: written copy for the five service pages. If the client is not supplying it, that is additional time.

11. Open Questions — Status

11.1 Resolved

- **Payment gateway at launch?** — No. Phase 1 is cash/manual. Phase 2 gateway decided as Stripe (Section 16).
- **Visual design direction** — Split Dock selected after comparing 4 directions (Section 13).
- **Hosting approach** — *Revised in Rev 2:* Hostinger **Business** managed hosting, replacing the Rev 1 self-managed VPS decision. See Section 12.
- **Backend language** — *New in Rev 2:* Next.js route handlers, replacing FastAPI. Single runtime.
- **Database engine** — *New in Rev 2:* MySQL, included with hosting, replacing self-hosted PostgreSQL.
- **Driver network** — Client already has drivers. No self-onboarding portal in Phase 1; existing drivers are entered into the driver list. Self-onboarding remains Phase 3.
- **Launch cities** — UAE cities with tourist relevance. Informs city-tour page priority (Section 14.2).

11.2 Still Open — Needs a Client Answer

- **Business entity structure** — Stripe requires a UAE sole establishment, branch, or free zone establishment (Section 16.2). Determines whether Stripe is usable or PayTabs is needed. *Highest priority: this also gates the legal name, domain, and merchant account, and has the longest lead time.*
- **Final business name** — Not yet finalised or domain-checked. Blocks branding, domain registration, and the merchant account.
- **Domain registration** — Does the client have a preferred registrar, or should this be set up as part of the project? (Hostinger bundles a free year-1 domain.)
- **Final Phase 1 page list sign-off** — The 10–12 page recommendation in Section 14.5 needs explicit approval, as it exceeds the original 4-screen plan.
- **Status enum** — Confirm whether `awaiting_confirmation` is genuinely distinct from `requested` (Section 5).

12. Hosting Decision (Revised)

Revision 1 selected a self-managed Hostinger VPS on cost grounds. Revision 2 reverses that. The cost analysis in Rev 1 was sound; the omission was **who maintains the server after the build ends**.

12.1 Why Not the VPS

A self-managed VPS means someone must apply security patches, monitor uptime, renew certificates, and recover from failure — indefinitely. The client is not technical. A server running unpatched Linux and holding customers' names, phone numbers and pickup addresses is a liability the client would be carrying without knowing it.

The business itself is manual, human coordination (Section 2). Client attention belongs on operations, not on server administration.

12.2 Option Comparison

	Managed Stack (Rev 1 "Option A")	Self-Managed VPS (Rev 1 "Option B")	Hostinger Business (Rev 2)
Year 1	~\$334–\$639	~\$84–\$105	~\$34 equivalent
Year 2+	~\$334–\$639	~\$144–\$192	~\$98 equivalent
Upfront commitment	Monthly	24-month lump	12-month term
Server maintenance	None	Ongoing, self-managed	None
SSL	Managed	Self-configured	Managed
Backups	Managed	Self-configured	Daily, included
Scaling	Automatic	Manual	Plan upgrade
Docker / background workers	Yes	Yes	No

12.3 What This Trades Away

Managed shared hosting cannot run Docker, background workers, cron containers, or any process outside the Node app. Nothing in Phase 1 or Phase 2 requires them. If Phase 3 introduces automated dispatch or scheduled jobs, a move to a VPS or a managed platform will be required — the application code does not change, only where it runs.

Not recommended: the Hostinger *Cloud* tiers (from ~Rs 2,099/month, renewing ~Rs 5,399/month). They cost more than the managed stack rejected in Rev 1 and buy capacity — 200,000+ monthly visits — that a pre-launch booking MVP will not approach.

12.4 Pre-Launch Staging (New)

The business name is not final, so the production domain and hosting cannot be purchased yet. Until then:

- Deploy to **Vercel free tier** on a `*.vercel.app` subdomain
- Use a **free hosted MySQL** (Aiven or TiDB Cloud serverless) — same engine as production, so migration is `mysqldump` + import
- At launch: dump/restore, change `DATABASE_URL`, point the domain (~10 minutes)

Two constraints: Vercel's Hobby tier prohibits commercial use, so this is strictly a pre-launch demo; and the staging app must not connect to Hostinger's MySQL, which restricts remote access by IP whitelist while Vercel's egress IPs are dynamic.

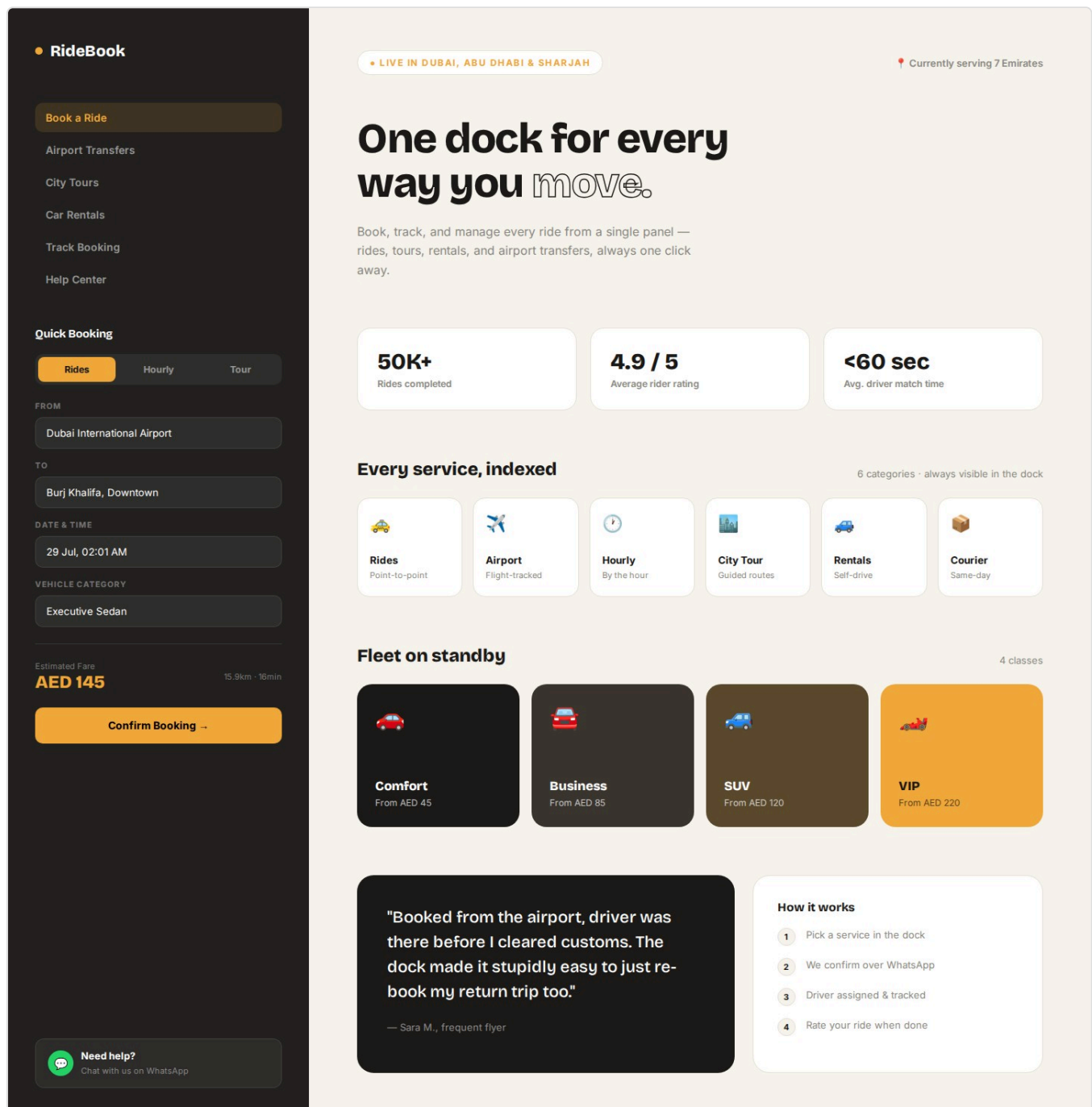
13. UI Mockups — Final Approved Design (Split Dock)

Unchanged from Revision 1.

After exploring four design directions (Split Dock, Aurora Bento, Heritage Editorial, App Showcase), **Split Dock** was selected. Its defining feature: a persistent left-hand panel holds the entire booking form (public pages) or admin navigation (admin dashboard), staying visible while content scrolls independently on the right.

13.1 Homepage

Persistent booking dock on the left (quick booking form, nav links, WhatsApp card) with marketing content — stats, service index, fleet, testimonial — scrolling on the right.



13.2 Booking Form

Full multi-step booking flow with a live trip summary and running fare total in the dock, so the customer always sees their booking state while filling in details.

RideBook

Book a Ride

Airport Transfers

City Tours

Car Rentals

Track Booking

Help Center

Booking Progress

Route

DXB → Burj Khalifa

Date

29 Jul, 02:01 AM

Vehicle

Executive

Distance

15.9km · 16min

Estimated

AED 145

Need help?

Chat with us on WhatsApp

Home / Book a Ride

Complete your booking

Fill in your trip details — we'll confirm availability over WhatsApp within minutes.

Rides

Book Hourly

City Tour

Airport

Trip Details

FROM

Dubai International Airport (DXB)

TO

Burj Khalifa, Downtown Dubai

PICKUP DATE

29 Jul 2026

PICKUP TIME

02:01 AM

Choose Vehicle

Comfort

From AED 45

Executive

From AED 85

SUV

From AED 120

VIP

From AED 220

Passenger Details

PASSENGERS

4

LUGGAGE

3

WHATSAPP NUMBER

+971 5X XXX XXXX

Back

Confirm Booking →

13.3 Admin Dashboard

The same dock shell switches to admin navigation (Bookings, Drivers, Vehicles, Reports, Settings) on the left, with the booking list, stats, and one-click driver assignment on the right.

RideBook

Admin Panel

Bookings

Drivers

Vehicles

Reports

Settings

Bookings

Search reference...

Pending
7

Assigned
4

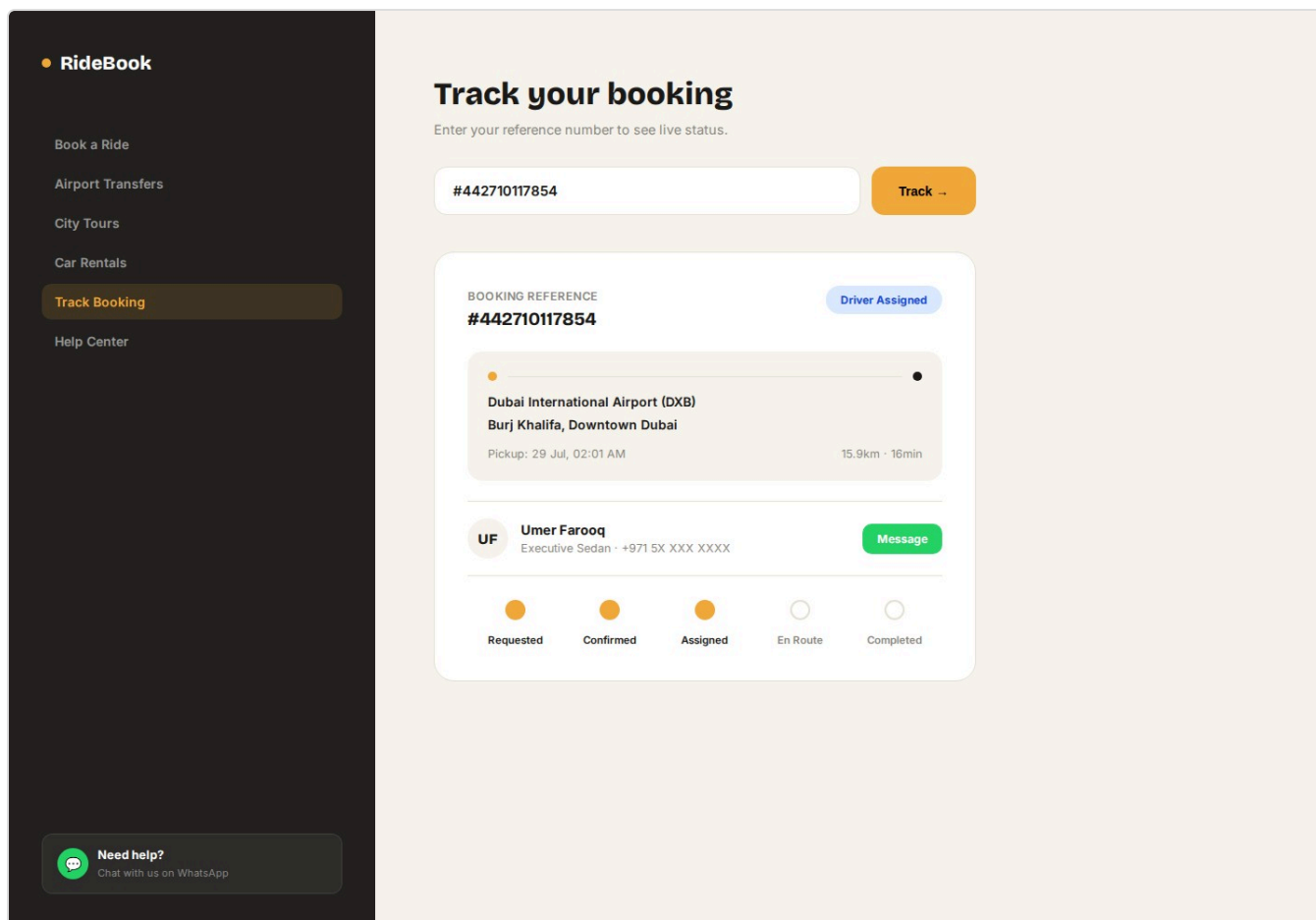
Completed Today
12

This Week
58

REFERENCE	CUSTOMER	ROUTE	STATUS	DRIVER	ACTION
#442710117854	Muhammad Hannan	DXB Airport → Burj Khalifa	Pending	—	Assign
#317729481203	Sara Malik	Marina Mall → Sharjah	Assigned	Umer Farooq	WhatsApp
#902281744410	Ahmed Raza	Home → DXB Airport	Done	Suleiman K.	—
#558820019233	Fatima Noor	Dubai Mall → Abu Dhabi	Pending	—	Assign
#671093820145	Khalid Omar	JBR → DXB Airport	Assigned	Rashid A.	WhatsApp

13.4 Public Tracking Page

Customer enters their reference code to see route, pickup time, assigned driver details, a direct WhatsApp contact button, and a visual status timeline (requested → confirmed → assigned → en route → completed).



14. Full Site Map — Reference Platform & Phase Planning

Unchanged from Revision 1. A scan of c2cride.com surfaced ~30 distinct pages — the mature, multi-year version of the business.

14.1 Service Pages (10)

Page	URL	Phase
Home	/	Phase 1
Rides	/rides	Phase 1 — SEO landing page
Airport Rides	/airport-rides	Phase 1 — high search intent
City Tour	/city-tour	Phase 1
Car Rentals	/car-rentals	Phase 1
Courier Service	/courier-service	Phase 2
Private Charter	/private-charter	Phase 2
Full Day Chauffeur	/full-day-luxury-chauffeur	Phase 2
Desert Safari	/premium-desert-safari	Phase 2
Rides for Business	/business-ride	Phase 2

14.2 City / Destination Tour Pages (7) — all Phase 2

Ranked by general tourism volume, for discussion — local knowledge of actual customer demand should override this generic ranking.

Page	URL	Priority
Dubai Tour	/dubai-tour	1 — highest volume
Abu Dhabi Tour	/abu-dhabi-tour	2 — Sheikh Zayed Mosque, Louvre
Ras Al Khaimah Tour	/ras-al-khaimah-tour	3 — Jebel Jais, adventure tourism
Sharjah Tour	/sharjah-tour	4 — cultural/heritage
Fujairah Tour	/fujairah-tour	5 — beach/mountain
Ajman Tour	/ajman-tour	6
Umm Al Quwain Tour	/umm-al-quwain-tour	7

14.3 Help & Legal Pages (8)

Page	URL	Phase
About Us	/about-us	Phase 1
FAQs	/faqs	Phase 1 — reduces WhatsApp support load
Contact Us	/contact-us	Phase 1
Support	/support	Phase 1 — can merge with Contact initially
Booking Conditions	/booking-conditions	Phase 1 — before accepting real bookings
Terms & Conditions	/terms	Phase 1
Privacy Policy	/privacy	Phase 1 — before collecting customer data
Account Deactivation	/account-reactivation	Phase 2

14.4 Business & Account Pages (5)

Page	URL	Phase
Travel Agencies	/travel-agencies	Phase 2
Corporate	/corporations	Phase 2
Holiday Homes	/holiday-homes	Phase 3 — separate vertical
Become a Partner	/become-partner	Phase 2
Login / Signup	/login	Phase 2

14.5 Recommended Phase 1 Page List — 10–12 pages

- **Service pages (5):** Home, Rides, Airport Rides, City Tour, Car Rentals — doubling as SEO landing pages rather than just tabs
- **Booking (2):** Booking Form, Track Booking
- **Trust (3):** About Us, FAQs, Contact Us
- **Legal (3):** Terms & Conditions, Privacy Policy, Booking Conditions
- **Admin (1):** Admin Dashboard — not public-facing

The extra pages are mostly content and reuse the same booking widget and layout components, rather than new systems. **Copy must be supplied or scoped separately** (see Section 10).

15. SEO Strategy

Unchanged from Revision 1. Note: Next.js still handles all of this natively — the stack change does not affect any item below.

15.1 Why This Matters Here

Local service searches ("airport transfer Dubai," "chauffeur service UAE") are dominated by Google's Local Pack and Maps results. Roughly a third of local ranking weight comes from Google Business Profile signals alone — meaning SEO here is as much about business-profile setup and reviews as it is about the website's code.

15.2 Technical SEO (Built In From Day One)

- Server-side rendering / static generation for all public pages
- Core Web Vitals as a hard requirement — fast LCP, low INP, stable layout
- Mobile-first design and testing
- HTTPS everywhere (included with managed hosting)
- Clean, descriptive URLs (`/airport-rides` , not `/page?id=4`)
- Auto-generated XML sitemap + correct `robots.txt` , submitted to Search Console
- Unique title tags and meta descriptions on every page

15.3 Structured Data

- `LocalBusiness` / `TransportationService` schema on the homepage
- `Service` schema on each service page
- `FAQPage` schema on the FAQ page
- `Review` / `AggregateRating` once real reviews exist

15.4 Local SEO (Highest-Impact Work)

- Set up and fully complete a **Google Business Profile** — correct primary category ("Airport Shuttle Service" or "Chauffeur Service", not generic), service area, hours, photos
- Keep **NAP** (Name, Address, Phone) perfectly consistent across site, profile, and directories
- Actively collect reviews after each ride — a WhatsApp follow-up is low-effort, high-impact
- List on relevant UAE directories

15.5 Content Strategy

- Each service gets a full landing page with real descriptive content, not just the booking widget
- City/destination pages (14.2) are a strong Phase 2 SEO play
- A real FAQ page captures long-tail traffic and reduces repetitive WhatsApp questions

15.6 Tracking & Ongoing Work

- Google Search Console and Analytics from launch day
- Track rankings, CTR, indexed page count monthly
- Expect measurable local ranking improvement in 3–6 months, not immediately

Recommendation: bake 15.2 and 15.3 into the build. Treat 15.4 as an operational task for whoever runs the business. Treat 15.5 as a deliberate follow-up phase.

16. Payment Gateway Strategy (Phase 2)

Unchanged from Revision 1. Payment is out of scope for Phase 1 — bookings are confirmed manually and paid offline.

16.1 What We Found on the Reference Platform

- Initial inspection suggested only "Pay with Card" / "Pay with Cash" with no visible custom checkout.
- Direct inspection of the live checkout resolved this: "Pay with Card" opens a hosted checkout at `checkout.stripe.com` — the reference platform uses **Stripe**.
- The Stripe page displays the merchant as "**C2C FZE LLC**", confirming a UAE Free Zone Establishment, and proving in practice that a UAE free-zone company can process live AED payments through Stripe.

16.2 Stripe & UAE Eligibility

UAE Business Structure	Stripe Eligible?
Sole establishment	Yes
Branch of a sole establishment	Yes
Free zone establishment (FZE)	Yes — confirmed by Stripe's docs and the reference platform's live checkout
Individual with no UAE-registered entity	No — a valid UAE trade license is required

16.3 Gateway Comparison

	Stripe	PayTabs	Geidea
Cards	Yes	Yes (+ Mada, UnionPay, Maestro)	Yes (+ Mada)
Apple Pay	Yes — confirmed live	Yes	Yes
Google Pay	Yes	Unconfirmed	Unconfirmed
PayPal	Region-limited	Yes	Unconfirmed
1-click repeat checkout	Yes (Link)	No	No
Published pricing	Yes — ~2.9% + fixed	Yes — from 2.85% + AED 1, free under AED 20,000/mo	No — sales contact only
Developer experience	Best-in-class	Good	Basic
Proven UAE precedent	Yes — reference platform	Common regionally	Common regionally

16.4 Recommendation

Stripe, subject to the client's entity structure being confirmed as eligible.

- If eligible: integrate **Stripe Checkout** (hosted page) for Card + Apple Pay + Google Pay.
- **Cash on Arrival** remains available in parallel, matching the manual booking flow.
- PayPal is not a priority — the reference platform doesn't offer it and UAE consumers use it far less than card/Apple Pay/Google Pay.
- If Stripe eligibility doesn't fit the final structure, **PayTabs** is the fallback.

17. Recommendations to the Client (New in Rev 2)

These sit outside the build itself but materially affect cost, risk, and outcome.

1. Sequence spending behind validation. Launch on a 12-month hosting term, not a multi-year prepaid plan. If the business works, upgrading is trivial. If it doesn't, the exposure is a few thousand rupees rather than a hundred thousand.

2. Avoid self-managed infrastructure. Covered in Section 12.1. The cost saving is real but small, and it is paid for with an ongoing maintenance obligation the client is not positioned to meet.

3. Every account in the client's name. Domain, hosting, database, Resend, Google Maps, Google Business Profile — registered to the client's email and card, with the developer added as a collaborator. This is a build being handed over as an asset, not a dependency. Clients are routinely stranded by infrastructure sitting in a former developer's personal account.

4. Resolve the business registration first. It is the longest-lead-time item, it is entirely outside the developer's control, and it gates the legal name, the domain, the branding, and the Phase 2 merchant account. Everything else in Section 11.2 has a workaround; this does not.

5. Start Local SEO now, not at launch. Google Business Profile setup, category selection, and review collection accrue value with age. Beginning during the build period rather than after it is free and is likely worth more than the entire technical SEO section.

End of Revision 2.